CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

PHOTO BOOTH / EVENT RENTALS OWNER IN THE AI ERA

Weddings and parties rent fun by the hour — you bring the booth, they bring the crowd.

★ TL;DR — Around $75K a year for an owner who builds a full book, set up in 1–6 months. The catch: it is weekend work sold months ahead — the business is bookings, not equipment. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

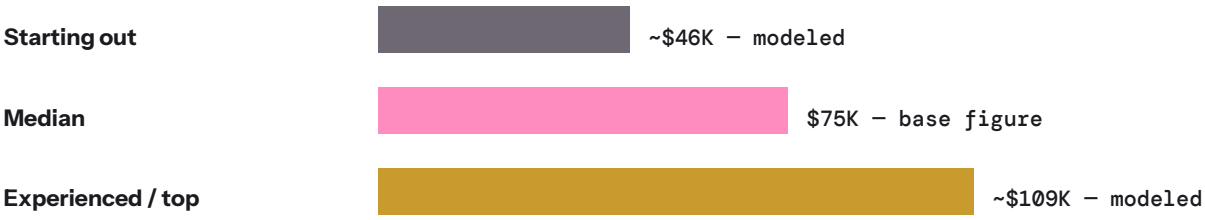
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Events are pre-booked and pre-paid — no waiting for walk-in customers.
- One rig can serve a wedding, a corporate party and a school dance in the same week.
- Planners are repeat buyers: one happy venue or planner can feed you all season.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Photo Booth / Event Rentals Owner is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A PHOTO BOOTH / EVENT RENTALS OWNER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Sell packages to couples, companies and event planners
- ✓ Deliver, set up and run the booth or rentals at events — mostly evenings and weekends
- ✓ Design overlays, backdrops and galleries for each client
- ✓ Maintain gear, manage bookings, reviews and the calendar

Think: a DJ without the music — you are paid to be the fun corner of somebody else's party.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI is inside the product now: instant filters, smart galleries, automated follow-ups and review requests. Booking, contracts and payments are fully software-run.	The night itself stays human: reading a shy crowd, rescuing a glitch mid-party, charming the planner who books twenty events a year. Presence is the premium.

⚠ **Weekends are the job — your Saturdays belong to other people's celebrations. And gear sitting in a garage earns nothing: a booth without bookings is an expensive toy.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Cheerful work — you are paid to attend parties ✓ Weekday freedom once bookings are set ✓ Small rig, small team, cash in before the event	✗ Friday and Saturday nights are work nights, period ✗ Seasonal swings: wedding season feasts, January starves ✗ Driving, loading and late-night breakdowns are real

Good fit? A people-person with weekend availability, sales energy and enough tech comfort to run modern booth software calmly in a loud room.
Bad fit? You guard your weekends, hate driving at night, or freeze when technology hiccups in front of a crowd.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — ONE BOOTH, DONE WELL	DOOR B — RENTALS BUNDLE
The lean start: one quality photo booth setup, a simple brand, packages for weddings and parties, and relentless planner outreach. Prove bookings first; add rigs when dates collide.	Start wider: booth plus the extras venues always need — lighting, audio guestbooks, backdrop walls, lawn games. Bigger tickets per event, more gear to store, haul and maintain.

Smart move: Give planners a reason to call you first: a planner-only rate card and next-day galleries with their logo on the folder. The couple books you once; the planner books you all year. Where you land after: Multiple rigs and hired attendants running simultaneous events — or a full event-rental company with the booth as its hook.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
DECIDE YOUR	SET UP	BUY THE	DO A	SELL TO	RUN THE

STEP 1 — Decide your event lane

FREE · 1 WEEK

- Weddings pay premium but book far ahead; corporate and school events fill the gaps. Sketch your mix before buying gear.
- Check what local venues and planners already offer — your angle is what they lack.

STEP 2 — Set up the business shell

$100-500 · 1-2 WEEKS

- Register the business, get liability insurance (many venues require it before you can work on site), open contracts and payment processing.
- Build one simple site: gallery, packages, availability request.

STEP 3 — Buy the rig for your lane

$2,000-8,000 · 2-4 WEEKS

- Booth, camera, lighting, printer, backdrops and spares — reliability beats novelty at a live event.
- Practice full setups at home until load-in to first photo takes minutes, not an hour.

STEP 4 — Do a proof event

FREE-$200 · 1 EVENT

- Run a real event cheap or free for photos, testimonials and brutal practice.
- Collect the planner's and venue's names — your follow-up list starts here.

STEP 5 — Sell to repeat buyers

$0-300 · ONGOING

- Visit venues and planners with a one-page rate card and your gallery.
- List on the directories couples actually search, and review-beg every client the morning after.

STEP 6 — Run the season like a calendar business PAID · ONGOING

- Deposits to hold dates, balances before the event, templates for every email.
- When two bookings want the same Saturday, that is your signal: second rig, first attendant.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: pick your event lane and list ten venues and planners you will pitch.
- □ Days 1–30: register, insure, buy the rig and rehearse setups until they are boring.
- □ Days 31–60: run a proof event, build the gallery, and pitch every planner on your list in person.
- □ Days 61–90: take paid bookings, collect reviews, and lock referral terms with two venues.
- □ Day 90: a booked calendar and a proven rig — growth is now just more dates and a second setup.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **BOOKINGS FIRST. GEAR SECOND.** ★